Children of Hope Child Development Center

November 2026

Hope Happenings:

News from Mrs. Mueller's Office

Buckle up—it's going to be a wild ride over the next few months!

We have so much to accomplish and so much fun to be had at school! Our theme for November is **thankfulness**, and we will be focusing on helping our little ones recognize just how blessed we are and how much we have to be thankful for. At the very top of our list are **our families!** Thank you for being part of this special little place and for blessing us with your support. We love what we do, and having such wonderful parent support makes this an extra-special place to work. We are so thankful for each and every one of you!

November is filled with fun fall lessons and activities. It's also the month when we finally get to take full advantage of our outdoor time! Wahoo! We will also observe Veterans Day on **November 11**, so there will be no school that day. School will also be closed on **November 25 and 26** for Thanksgiving.

- **November 2:** Final day to order Butter Braids
- **November 13:** Fun Friday for those who are interested! We will be making Thanksgiving crafts, decorations, and other fun items to celebrate.
- **November 17:** Butter Braid orders will be delivered to the school.
- **November 19:** Staff Meeting- No Lunch Bunch
- **November 20:** Deadline for Scholastic book orders. If you would like to order books for Christmas, please be sure to submit your order by this date.
- **November 11, 25 & 26:** No school

We will wrap up the month with our annual **Thanksgiving Feast!** Each class will create its own placemats and decorations to make our tables festive and beautiful. We will finish the day together outside in our back courtyard, sharing a special time of food, friendship, and thankfulness. We will begin gathering in the courtyard at **11:30 a.m.**

It's almost time for our annual Christmas Store, and we would love your help! We are collecting donations of small trinkets, unused soaps and lotions, cute hand towels, elf legs, and so much more. Please take a look around at home to see if you have any items you would like to donate.

In December, your child will have the opportunity to shop at our Christmas Store for the special people on their gift list. We ask for a small donation of **$3–$5 per person** your child shops for. The wonderful ladies from our church generously volunteer their time to wrap and label each gift, so your little one gets to take home a bag of beautifully wrapped treasures to share with family and friends.

Happy Birthday!



STAFF Birthday: October

Mrs. Paterson- 11th

Mrs. Baldwin- 15th

This is a wonderful opportunity for our children to learn the joy of giving and thinking of others. Because of that, we try to keep the focus on shopping for loved ones rather than for themselves.

Thank you, as always, for being such an important part of our school family. We have so much to be thankful for, and we look forward to sharing a fun-filled November with all of you!

Blessings,

Mrs. Mueller

HOPE esperanza
LUTHERAN CHURCH

Church Events:

November 1st, 8th 15th and 22nd Sunday School

November 22nd- Playing and Praying with Deacon Connie

No Sunday School Nov 29th



Chapel starts at 8:30 and everyone is welcome to attend.



Gliders-Monday- 16th
Owlets- Tuesday-17th
Penguins- Wednesday-18th

You and your child will meet your classroom teacher up in the sanctuary. Chapel generally lasts 15-20 minutes.



Pick Up at 1:00pm: $15
Pick Up at 2:00pm: $20
Will invoice via Brightwheel daily and is payable on next month's tuition.

NO LUNCH BUNCH on November 19th due to staff meeting

Butter Braid orders due:

November 2nd

Butter Braid pickup and delivery:

November 17th



No School- Nov. 11th to observe Veteran's Day



School Board meeting-Tuesday, November 17th @ 6:00 PM



Fun Friday-November 13th

Theme: Thanksgiving Decorations

Mrs. Mueller and Friend

Join us for an additional day of fun from 8:30-12:00 pm (no Lunch Bunch) noon.



Thanksgiving Feast- November 24th

11:30 Join us in the back courtyard for our all school
Feast!



Monthly Staff Meeting

Thursday, November 19th @ 12:00pm

This means no lunch bunch on this day and all friends need to be picked up at



No School November 25th or 26th for the Thanksgiving Holdiay



Backpack Connection Series

About this Series

The Backpack Connection Series was created by TACSEI to provide a way for teachers and parents/caregivers to work together to help young children develop social emotional skills and reduce challenging behavior. Teachers may choose to send a handout home in each child's backpack when a new strategy or skill is introduced to the class. Each Backpack Connection handout provides information that helps parents stay informed about what their child is learning at school and specific ideas on how to use the strategy or skill at home.

The Pyramid Model

The Pyramid Model is a framework that provides programs with guidance on how to promote social emotional competence in all children and design effective interventions that support young children who might have persistent challenging behavior. It also provides practices to ensure that children with social emotional delays receive intentional teaching. Programs that implement the Pyramid Model are eager to work together with families to meet every child's individualized learning and support needs. To learn more about the Pyramid Model, please visit ChallengingBehavior.org.

More Information

More information and resources on this and other topics are available on our website, ChallengingBehavior.org.

National Center for Pyramid Model INNOVATIONS

ChallengingBehavior.org

How to Give Clear Directions

Brooke Brogle, Alyson Jiron & Jill Giacomini

"Why do I have to repeat myself time and again?" "Why won't she listen to me?" Listening and following directions are important skills young children must learn. There are many reasons why children do not follow directions.

- **The child does not hear the direction.** Parents often give directions from a distance or in passing. "Lauren, get your shoes on." Did your child actually hear what you said? Just as adults often don't hear what their partner has said to them because they are focused on reading, email or talking on the phone, children too often don't hear what a parent has said because they are focused on a task such as building a tower or drawing a picture.
- **The parent gives too many directions at one time.** When you give your child too many directions at one time, it reduces the chance that she will follow the directions and increases the chance that she will be confused. "Lauren, please go upstairs, brush your teeth and pick up your blocks while I finish the dishes." This multi-step direction is too long and complicated for your child to easily understand. Instead, try giving one direction at a time.
- **The child doesn't understand the direction or the direction is too vague.** Directions such as "Settle down," "stop," or "be nice" might be too vague and difficult for your child to understand. If she is throwing toys out of the bathtub and you simply say, "Lauren," you have not actually told her what you want her to do. If you say, "stop it," it may temporarily stop the behavior, but she still may not know what you want her to do. If what you mean is, "Lauren, toys stay in the tub," then you need to explicitly tell her so.
- **The direction does not tell the child what to do.** Parents often tell children what not to do, rather than what they should do. It is important to state directions positively in order to teach your child the expectation. Instead of saying, "Stop running!", state the direction positively by saying, "Use walking feet."
- **The direction sounds like a suggestion or question.** Daily conversation is filled with questions, suggestions and directions. When you say, "Will you put your shoes away?" you are not giving your child a direction—you are asking her a question. When you give your child a direction that needs to be followed, it is essential that you tell your child what to do rather than ask. For example, "Lauren, put your shoes by the door."

Try This at Home

- It is important to follow through when you give your child a direction. A technique you can use to make sure you do follow through when your child has difficulty complying, or following directions is Do-WAWP.
  - Do—State the "do" direction.
  - W—Wait for compliance (silently count to 5).
  - A—Ask the child to restate the direction.
  - W—Wait for compliance (silently count to 5).
  - P—Provide encouragement or help (helping will ensure success).
- **Make sure that you have your child's attention.** Eye contact is a great indicator! When you state the "do" direction you are teaching your child the desired behavior. For instance, "Lauren, go brush your teeth." When you count to five, you are giving her the opportunity to hear and process the direction. Parents often repeat the same direction over and over in that five second period. When you repeat the same direction to your child time and again, it teaches her that she does not have to follow the direction the first time. Instead, state the direction once and then have your child restate the direction back to you. This way you can confirm that she heard you and understood what you were saying. Finally, offering help may simply mean that you take her hand and lead her to the bathroom. Don't forget to encourage your child by saying something like, "Wow, Lauren, what great listening ears! Thank you for brushing your teeth."



Practice at School

In addition to verbal instructions, teachers use many methods to give directions and help children understand expectations. These methods may include using symbols or pictures, sign language or gestures, songs, puppets, instruments, sand timers, or other tools. The more opportunities children are given to see or hear the instructions, the more likely they are to complete the task. For example, when teachers need to tell the class that it is time to go inside from the playground, in addition to words they may use a sound (e.g., ring a bell) to alert the children about this event. Children know that the sound means that it is time to line up at the door, even if they do not hear the verbal instructions. When teachers pair words with other signals, they help children to confidently and successfully participate in activities.

The Bottom Line

Listening and following directions are skills that children learn through their daily interactions. When children do not follow directions, for any reason, it can be extremely frustrating for parents. You can increase the chances that your child will listen and successfully follow your directions when you make sure that your direction is clearly stated and you follow through.

An important consideration for parents when teaching their child to follow directions is to "pick your battles". You want to avoid insisting that your child follow directions that are not important or can escalate to a major struggle when the direction is not critical. Pick a few, very important directions that you will follow-through with your child.

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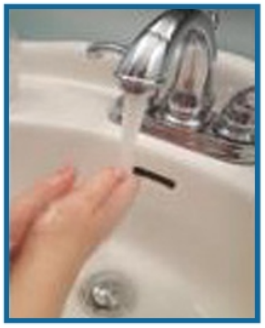
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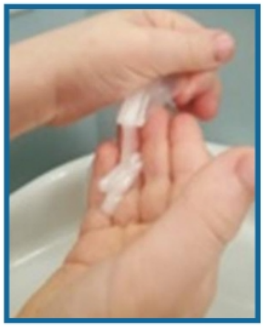
HANDWASHING VISUAL



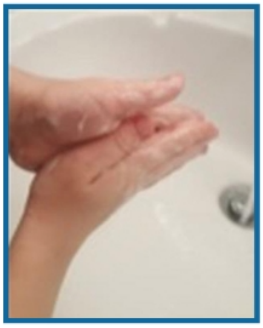
1. Turn on warm water. Use towel if possible.



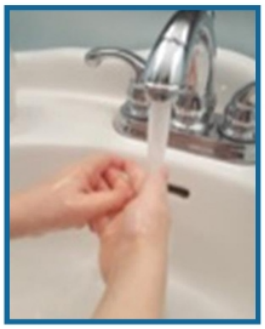
2. Wet hands with water.



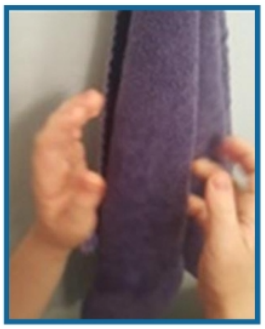
3. Apply liquid soap. Use wrist or back of hand if possible.



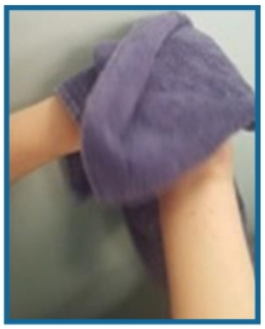
4. Wash for at least 20 seconds. Rub top and inside of hands, under nails and between fingers.



5. Rinse hands under running water for at least 10 seconds.



6. Find your own towel or a clean, disposable paper towel.



7. Dry hands with your own towel or a disposable paper towel.



8. Turn off water, ideally with your towel.

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Please make drop off and pick up times with your child

NO CELL PHONE ZONES ☺

SMOKE-FREE ENVIRONMENT

We at Children of Hope Child Development Center are committed to providing a smoke-free environment for children, staff members, and childcare providers. Due to hazards from exposure to second-hand smoke and as a recognized Empower childcare facility, it shall be the policy of this childcare facility to provide a tobacco-free environment for children, staff members, childcare providers, and parents.

CITY WIDE FACILITY SOLUTIONS

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